

Cloud PCs will reign

WE'RE ALL AVID PC USERS AT DIGIT. THERE'S NO HIDING THAT FACT, AND IN REALITY,

most of us wear the PC Master Race badge on our sleeves, and keep pointing to it every chance we get! Needless to say, the overwhelming majority of people at Team Digit are also Windows users, because... gaming!

Therefore it was obvious that when a new version of Windows is announced, we're all running about, indulging in illegal downloads, scrambling together makeshift PCs to try it out on, or just backing up existing ones to try and use the latest build. Until it is finally released at the end of the year, we will be doing this often, and even writing stories about it, making videos, and more.

This is all expected, and honestly there's nothing shocking about that. We did the same thing for Windows 10, 8.1, 7, XP, 98... yes I'm aware I skipped Windows 8, Windows Vista and Windows 2000, ME, and I did it on purpose, because I don't want horrific memories of those disasters returning!

With Windows 11, Microsoft is hoping to break the jinx of every alternate release being terrible.

Microsoft wants us to compute seamlessly with Windows 11, and no doubt is trying at least to woo us into using Android apps on our PCs, so that we feel more at home and can pick up where we left off while on the go with our smartphones. How good or bad the implementation will decide the fate of their bet, but at least we can see what they're attempting to do.

Much more revealing is their foray into Windows 365, which we haven't really touched upon in our cover story because it's all still too new, and we really know nothing about it. Set to launch on August 2, 2021, Windows 365 is essentially Microsoft's answer to computing on demand. Is this somehow a new concept? Heck no! The idea of thin clients using beefy servers to compute is decades old, and even cloud-based computing allowing us to get access to much more computational power on the go is something Google wanted to do with Chrome OS and Chromebooks as well. What Google didn't have was the sheer legacy of Microsoft Windows, where most corporations and businesses have software that runs on Microsoft's platform, and is designed for it. Even today almost everyone would choose a full-

fledged Windows laptop (or a Macbook) over a Chromebook if money was not a problem.

With the reality setting in of there being a new way of working, even after the pandemic is somehow controlled, businesses of all sizes need to prepare for a significant percentage of their staff working remotely. Even schools, colleges and universities will have to embrace remote learning, and we can't have individuals all across the world breaking the bank to buy themselves powerful hardware capable of running their work apps.

With Windows 365, and everyone working remotely needing a decent net connection anyway, you could potentially run a powerful machine even on a potato laptop, or a tablet, or even your smartphone! They're talking about a virtual machine (Microsoft call it a 'Cloud PC') with 8 CPU cores, 16 GB RAM and 512 GB of storage, ready to do your bidding in just a few minutes or even seconds after you log in. They're also researching GPU integration, so you could get GPU power to do stuff like speeding up rendering, or video processing, or even gaming!

Obviously Microsoft is not targeting this at consumers, and is focussed on small businesses all the way up to large corporations – which is Microsoft's main focus when it comes to Windows anyway. We will see the benefits of this as consumers though, as enterprise tech usually does trickle its way into the lives of consumers at some point or the other.

Whether it will be Windows 365, or some other player who comes in and innovates their way into the position of power in this space, it's coming! We're going to be computing from wherever we are, spinning up these powerful Cloud PCs on command, saving a lot of time and working only a few hours, and then going back to life as it happens. Using our phones, tablets, or thin clients at the local shared workspace, we're going to have a Windows PC available on demand for when we need it, and our companies are going to have everything stored on the cloud, so we can retrieve, use and work on files in real time. We could have been doing this all these years anyway... all it took was for a nanoscale virus to disrupt the world, shake us awake, and show us that these idiotic self imposed shackles we were wearing could indeed be broken free from. We're all coming back home to the PC now, and soon we will all be part of a Virtual PC Master Race. Embrace the change, it's good! 📺



Windows 98	Good
Windows Me	Ugh!
Windows XP	Wow
Windows Vista	👎👎👎👎👎
Windows 7	GOAT
Windows 8	Eww!
Windows 10	Nice
Windows 11	??



Liked or hated this column? Let me know at: robert@digit.in | facebook.com/raaabo | [@raaabo](https://t.me/raaabo) | t.me/digitgeek | discord.gg/myD8Xvt | [WhatsApp: +91 98211 69631](https://whatsapp.com/+919821169631)